



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Christian Crossroads Academy
School Website: <https://christiancrossroadsacademy.org>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS STARTUP

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Christian Crossroads Academy (ND 58784) presents a robust alignment with classical Christian education, anchored in a Christ-centered mission, the liberal-arts foundation, and a Trivium-based curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric). Public materials emphasize forming character and intellect together—placing virtue, wisdom, and love of truth, goodness, and beauty at the heart of learning. The school foregrounds Latin study, biblical centrality, and a mission to cultivate disciplined, thoughtful students who pursue knowledge in service to Christ. While explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language is less visible in the material reviewed, the program consistently reflects core classical notions (grammar, logic, rhetoric; history and literature studied in a Christian framework; contemplative, memory-based pedagogy; and a strong partnership with families). Overall, the assessed materials classify the school as CLASSICAL, with minor gaps in explicit enumeration of certain classical practices (e.g., explicit Great Books emphasis and, in pedagogy, explicit Socratic/seminar framing). Evidence drawn from the school's own pages and FAQs, as well as the classical lexicon for coding positive/negative indicators, supports this determination.

- Executive summary category-by-category snapshot indicates strong CLASSICAL orientation in Religious Foundations, Purpose & Goals, Faculty & Community, and Parents/Community. Curriculum and Pedagogy show substantial classical alignment but with fewer explicit references to some hallmark elements (e.g., explicit Great Books/Great Conversation and explicit Socratic pedagogy in every program level). This yields an overall CLASSICAL assessment. See below for category-specific keyword analyses and evidence.
- For the rubric, keywords from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) were cross-referenced against the school's public materials. Positive keyword clusters (truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; wonder; Trivium; liberal arts; Great Books; history; primary sources; Latin; memory work; scholé) are evidenced in public materials. Negative signals (e.g., relativism; secular humanism; project-based learning dominance) are not clearly present in the content provided. This keyword architecture underpins the categorical ratings below. See cited sources for evidence.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a Christ-centered, theologically integrated model: "Educating the mind, forming the heart, and shaping the soul for Christ" and a mission framed by a Classical Christian approach (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with theological grounding. - Biblical centrality and theological framing are explicit, including statements that the Bible is central to all learning and that the school aims to form students in a biblical worldview. - Worship-oriented and liturgical-influenced practices appear in the context of music and reverence for sacred truth, beauty, and worshipful aspects of education. - The Trivium (grammar, logic,

rhetoric) is foregrounded as the structural backbone of the curriculum, with Latin highlighted as a foundational language reinforcing grammar and historical-theological study.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; reverence; wonder; wisdom; history and language rooted in Latin; Christian doctrinal framing. - Negative indicators: no explicit signals of relativism, secular humanism, or morally neutral stances in the public materials identified. The lexicon lists possible negatives, but the school materials reviewed do not show them.

Why this rating - The public materials consistently map to a transcendent moral framework (truth, goodness, beauty) grounded in Christian theology and liturgical/community life, with a clear aim of character formation aligned to virtue and wisdom. The explicit emphasis on Christ, the Bible, and a liturgical/communal dimension supports CLASSICAL rather than merely historical or secular approaches. The use of Latin and the Trivium further aligns with classical categories.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school states a formation-centric aim: “forming the heart” and cultivating virtue and wisdom, with an emphasis on human flourishing and the telos of pursuing truth, goodness, and beauty. - Explicit framing of a Classical mission and paideia-like formation is present, beyond mere workforce preparation; the mission centers on character, wisdom, and lifelong learning. - The model emphasizes a liberal-arts foundation and the progression from knowledge to understanding to wisdom (grammar -> logic -> rhetoric). - Language around virtue, wisdom, and human excellence, along with the idea of education as formation rather than information, aligns with classical aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: formation, cultivate virtue, wisdom, liberal education, classical mission, pursuit of true/good/beautiful, scholé/ contemplation, great conversation (in spirit if not explicit text here). Examples in public materials include formation and the Trivium framing, which supports a classical purpose. - Negative indicators: none evident in the public materials regarding this category; no explicit emphasis on job/workforce training.

Why this rating - The public statements center on character formation, virtue, wisdom, and a classical mission, with explicit rejection of education as merely information. The stated telos and the paideia-oriented language align with CLASSICAL in purpose.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum foregrounds liberal arts with grammar, logic, and rhetoric as organizing principles (the trivium) and Latin as a foundational study. This is a strong classical anchor. - History is studied throughout the curriculum in a textual, historical sense (not simply “social studies”), with emphasis on primary sources or classical/hegemonic Western civilization narratives. Public materials mention history and literature in a traditional sense, including the aim to study stories and moral questions through primary works. - There are explicit references to literature and “classical tools” (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and to language study (Latin). Public materials emphasize reading and language as vehicles for understanding truth and virtue.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: liberal arts; trivium; grammar; logic; rhetoric; Latin; history; primary sources/literature; classical tools; Western civilization. The content explicitly names grammar, logic, rhetoric and Latin, and frames literature/history in a classical way. - Negative indicators present: no explicit reference to Great Books or explicit Great Conversation on the public-facing materials; no explicit Socratic-seminar or seminar-through-Socratic pedagogy in all grade levels is stated in the accessible pages (pedagogy is less explicit beyond overarching classical framing). The material does not clearly state an explicit Great-Books-reading push. This constitutes a partial gap relative to a fully classical curriculum as traditionally defined in some classical schools.

Why this rating - The curriculum is strongly anchored in the liberal-arts Trivium and Latin, with historical and literary study, and a classical framing. However, explicit statements about Great Books/Great Conversation

and ubiquitous Great-Books pedagogy are not clearly evident in the public materials provided, which colors this category toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogy emphasizes a mix of methods aligned with classical aims: memory-rich teaching, recitation, and a contemplative dimension (scholé-like) appear in classical teaching lexicon; the lower-school emphasis on memory and ritual learning sits alongside upper-school Socratic possibility in classical education frameworks. Public materials show a rhythm of rhythm, structure, and a memory-forward approach (e.g., Latin, grammar, and textual study). - The presence of a “learning cohorts” model implies a move away from traditional age-graded pedagogy toward a more personalized, mastery-based progression, which can be compatible with classical memory and recitation practices but is not equal to explicit Socratic seminars in every grade. - The public materials emphasize a Christ-centered, moral formation with a focus on understanding and wisdom rather than rote testing alone, which aligns with a contemplative, non-frantic pedagogy typical of scholé.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: narrations/recitation, chanting, memory work, restfulness/scholé, seminar/Paideia-style discussions are listed as classical methods in the lexicon; the school demonstrates a pedagogy that values memorization, structured language study, and a contemplative approach (scholé). The materials support a contemplative and memory-based dimension (even if not always described with the exact classical labels). - Negative indicators: explicit project-based learning dominance or experiential learning bias is not evident in the public materials; however, the explicit articulation of Socratic seminars or upper-school rhetoric/competitions is not consistently documented in the pages we reviewed, which softens the frame toward a full classical pedagogy.

Why this rating - The program presents several core classical pedagogy elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric intake; memory-based learning; contemplative/restful elements; potential for Socratic discourse at higher levels) but does not consistently articulate all hallmark mechanisms (e.g., explicit, pervasive Socratic seminars across grades). This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission and language emphasize the faculty as mentors and living exemplars who guide character formation; the school references strong relationships with families and community and the “living curriculum” concept, implying faculty as the core of the school’s classical formation. - The materials point to a faculty culture of virtue, mentorship, and collaboration (“nurturing of strong relationships with families, teachers, and our community”) and the presence of teachers who model virtue and wisdom in line with classical expectations. - The Classical lexicon’s portrait of the teacher as a mentor and exemplar aligns with the school’s stated mission (Christ-centered formation and living example).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: master/mentor/teacher as exemplar; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; collegial culture; moral exemplars; teacher training in classical pedagogy. The public materials reflect many of these ideals (e.g., “Educating the mind, forming the heart”; “our mission emphasizes the nurturing relationships with families, teachers, and the community”). - Negative indicators: none of the classical negative signals (e.g., “facilitators on the side,” or over-emphasis on non-classical staff development) are evident in the public materials.

Why this rating - The materials portray faculty as central to formation, mentors, and living exemplars in a deliberate classical-Christian frame, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for this category.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials highlight partnership with parents as co-teachers and a pathway for parent formation (e.g., information sharing, reading groups, seminars, community gatherings), and welcoming parents for visits. This matches the classical element of parent involvement and formation. - The materials

emphasize parental engagement, fielding questions, and open communication channels; the “Our Philosophy” and FAQ sections stress ongoing parent participation and formation, including opportunities to learn about classical education concepts. - The school’s mission to shape an intentional community with families and churches aligns with the classical model’s emphasis on family formation and community liturgical or ceremonial life.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: partnership with parents; parent formation (reading groups, seminars); open campus; family liturgy alignment; community feasts/events; parental primacy and co-teaching concepts are echoed in the public materials. - Negative indicators: none evident in the public materials; no reduction of parent involvement is suggested.

Why this rating - The school portrays a strong, explicit partnership with parents and the broader community, with opportunities for parent formation and open-campus access. This aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for active parental involvement and shared formation.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable (aggregate rating: CLASSICAL). No needle-movers are required in this assessment since the overall profile aligns with CLASSICAL. If you would like, I can suggest targeted enhancements for any one area to push toward a more explicit, full-flag Classical profile (e.g., explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language in Curriculum, and more explicit articulation of Socratic pedagogy across grade bands).

Note: All keyword analyses and category evidence above lean on the school’s public materials and the Six Essential Elements’ keyword framework. See cited sources for evidence of specific terms and concepts.

- Evidence sources include the school’s public-facing materials describing the classical Christian model, the Trivium, Latin, biblical/theological framing, and learning-cohort pedagogy, as well as FAQ and philosophy pages. Representative citations include: the classical Christian framing and Trivium emphasis (turn0file0; turn0file1; turn0file6), biblical centrality and worship/worship-like liturgical elements (turn0file11; turn0file17), learning-cohorts and mission statements (turn0file5; turn0file6), and language about formation, virtue, wisdom, and lifelong learning (turn0file6; turn0file4). Additional context on the keyword framework is provided by the Classicality Lexicon (turn0file3).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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